

X-Box 360 Wi-Fi Edition

Microsoft has announced a new X-Box 360 that is slimmer and runs quieter than the previous version and features inbuilt Wi-Fi

iPhone 4 pre orders

AT&T has suspended pre ordering after over 6,00,000 orders were placed for Apple's shiny new beauty

ASUS EAH5850

Black (n red) beauty!

The HD5850 is a very interesting proposition because cards on this GPU are generally well priced, and offer good value for money. The performance level is also sufficient to drive most games on a resolution of 1920 x 1200. The smaller size of the card and lower heat dissipation also makes Cross-fire an option worth considering. Temperatures on idle were

around 44 degrees. Load temperatures hovered around the 60-degree mark. As compared to an ASUS ENGTX 285 graphic card (14,739 3D Marks), the card gave 15,868 in 3D Mark Vantage. The GPU score was 14,828 to 11,945 – a sure win for the newcomer. Here's a look at how it did in a few games, for reference we've added the GTX 285 as well.



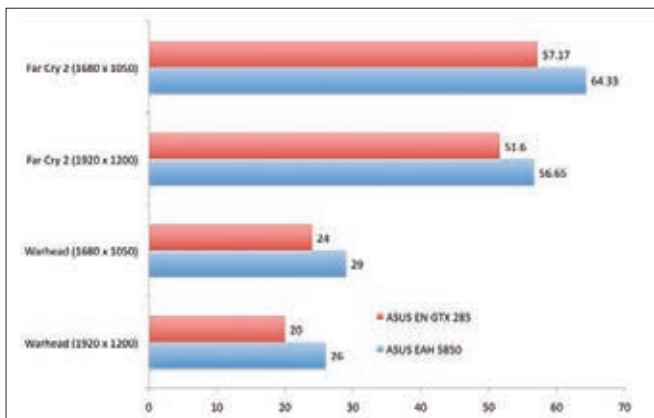
We also got a score of 744 (29.5 fps) in Unigine's DX11 benchmark Heaven 2.0. Tessellation was set to normal. With Extreme Tessellation, the frames dip to 17.8 and the score falls to 448; all the while Anisotropic filtering was kept at 4x. Not a bad showing at all, *Call of Pripayat* managed a respectable average fps of 51.8 at 1920 x 1200, with 4x AA and DX11 enabled – this is pretty good. What isn't good, is the price – at Rs. 29,250, ASUS charges close to what a GTX 480 sells for, and well over Sapphire's HD 5870 – both better cards. Too much to pay for a premium brand tag.

Specifications

No of SPs: 1440; Core Clock: 725 MHz; Memory Interface: 256-bit, GDDR5; Memory Clock: 1 GHz (4 GHz GDDR5); Memory: 1 GB; Shader Model: 5.0 (DX11)

Contact

ASUS India
Phone: 1800-2090-365
Email: info_india@asus.com
Web site: www.asus.in
Price: Rs. 29,250 (excluding tax)

**Specifications**

Capacity: 4 GB; Outer covering: Hard rubber

Contact

Technology and Gadgets
Phone: +91 22 3874440/1/2
Email: www.technologyandgadgets.com
Web site: kalpesh_tag@hotmail.com
Price: Rs. 525

4/10

Features.....5
Performance.....2
Build Quality.....7
Value for money.....3

Patriot Xporter Mini 4 GB

Painfully slow

Patriot Memory's Xporter mini is a 4GB flash drive which is housed in a rubberised casing. Measuring less than two inches in length, this drive is extremely portable and resistant to wear and tear thanks to the rubber casing. We tested the flash drive on an Intel X58 board having Kingston HyperX 2 GB DDR3 RAM and a 300 GB WD Velociraptor hard drive. In the synthetic tests like HD Tach it gave very low read and write scores. For both



the 8 MB as well as 32 MB files, the average read was just 9.3 MB/s and average write around 3.5 MB/s with read burst speeds touching a maximum of 10.2 MB/s. Real life data transfer tests also gave very miniscule scores. We took a 1 GB file for both read and write tests. A single file write took 270 seconds (3.7 MB/s) whereas an

assorted file took 400 seconds (2.5 MB/s). Reading data from the Xporter Mini took 108 seconds (9.25 MB/s) for a single file whereas an assorted file took 123 seconds (8.13 MB/s).

At a price of Rs. 525, this drive is decently priced. Go for it only if you have no other option. Ideally we would not recommend this drive.